Issues to watch in ETS and aviation

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【要点】

・ETS（排出権取引制度）の見直しにおいて、航空業界はEU発着便への炭素価格設定の拡大だけでなく、持続可能な航空燃料と零排出航空機技術の支援強化も求めている。

・地域航空会社の主な課題は、EU全体での地理的範囲の拡大ではなく、欧州各空港での持続可能な航空燃料への不平等なアクセスであり、アクセス権と物理的な燃料供給を分離する「ブック・アンド・クレーム制度」の導入を要望している。

・欧州委員会は7月1日までにCORSIA炭素相殺メカニズムの環境的完全性の評価をEU議会と閣僚理事会に提出することが義務付けられていたが、両機関はまだ受け取っていない。

・ETS見直しの最大の争点は、EU発着便への拡大であり、当初予定より2日遅れて7月17日に延期された。

【メール原文】

Presented by IRU By TOMMASO LECCA with MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — The ETS review could shape the transition to sustainable fuels and electric aviation

Presented by IRU

By TOMMASO LECCA

with MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— The ETS review could shape the transition to sustainable fuels and electric aviation, even as the debate remains focused on its possible extension to all departing flights.

— Europe’s automotive and truck industries are urging the Commission not to reopen the bloc’s electric vehicle transition.

— Cruise passengers pay significantly less tax than hotel guests despite the sector’s environmental footprint, says a new study.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

ETS REVIEW IS ABOUT MORE THAN ITS EXTENSION TO ALL FLIGHTS: Airlines and next-generation aircraft developers want the upcoming review of the Emissions Trading System for aviation to do more than decide whether to extend carbon pricing to all flights departing from the EU.

They are also pushing the European Commission to use the revision to better support sustainable aviation fuels and zero-emission aircraft technologies. Yet in recent weeks, the political debate has focused almost exclusively on the system's geographical scope.

The most contentious element of the review — postponed earlier this week to July 17, two days later than originally planned — remains the possible extension of the ETS to all flights departing from the EU. The Commission was required to submit by July 1 its assessment of the environmental integrity of the U.N.'s CORSIA carbon-offsetting mechanism to Parliament and the Council. Both institutions told Tommaso they have yet to receive it.

Look at the bigger picture: According to Montserrat Barriga, director general of the European Regions Airline Association, "we are looking at the wrong geographical problem." Regional airlines, most of which operate primarily within the EU, argue that the real priority is addressing unequal access to SAF across European airports. Many carriers are unable to access either the SAF itself or the ETS credits linked to its use.

"Expanding the scope of the EU ETS will not make the system work better," Barriga said. "The real gap already exists within the current framework: some regional airlines are bearing the cost of SAF but cannot access the ETS incentive because it remains tied to the physical availability of SAF at the airports they serve."

Longtime request: Regional carriers want the Commission move toward a book-and-claim system, which would separate eligibility for ETS credits from the physical use of SAF by each airline. If introduced into both the ETS and ReFuelEU Aviation rules, the mechanism would "ensure the system works as intended and rewards emissions reductions wherever they are achieved," Barriga said.

Electric pioneers: Developers of electric aircraft also hope the ETS will create incentives to accelerate the deployment of their technologies once they reach the market. Aura Aero and Væridion are asking the Commission to extend the current carbon allowance under the Fuels Eligible for ETS mechanism to electric flights expected to enter commercial service during the next decade. The proposed credits would be known as E-FEETS.

From laggards to models: The companies argue that the new credits would help airlines offset the costs of operating electric aircraft, making short-haul routes — increasingly targeted by some governments as a source of avoidable emissions — a cornerstone of aviation decarbonization. "We believe the EU ETS mechanism is a very important one to support industrial ambitions but also operational deployment," said Alessia Affinito of Væridion.

"DG CLIMA has responded positively to our suggestion to further use free allowances to deploy electric aviation, which should be reflected in the context of the EU ETS revision," added Aura Aero's Antoine Toulemont.

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ROAD TRANSPORT

INDUSTRY URGES BRUSSELS TO STICK WITH ELECTRIFICATION: Some European automotive and truck companies don't want the Commission to reopen the bloc's electric vehicle transition, warning that repeated regulatory changes are undermining investment just as electrification is gathering pace.

Don't change course: Speaking to POLITICO, Francesca Gamboni, chief industrial operations officer at Volvo Cars, said regulatory certainty is now more important than new legislation. She criticized repeated revisions to vehicle CO2 targets and proposals to weaken the 2035 phaseout of combustion engines, arguing that "continuous changes are affecting dramatically the transition" by slowing investment and eroding confidence among consumers and investors.

Industrial warning: Gamboni also cautioned against moving too quickly on some of the Commission's proposed "Made in Europe" requirements under the Industrial Accelerator Act. While supporting the objective, she argued Europe currently lacks sufficient manufacturing capacity for some EV components, which risks making electric vehicles more expensive before domestic supply chains are ready.

The truck case: Anja van Niersen, CEO of Milence, argued that electric trucks should be viewed as part of Europe's energy system rather than simply another transport technology. Because freight routes and charging patterns are highly predictable, she said trucks can become large-scale energy storage assets, helping stabilize electricity grids while reducing oil demand.

No more U-turns: Both executives urged Brussels to stop reopening settled policy files and instead focus on implementing existing legislation. Van Niersen called for clear long-term policy signals, faster charging infrastructure deployment backed by European derisking mechanisms and stronger demand incentives for commercial fleets. "We don't need more laws," she said. "We need a very concrete, diligent implementation of what we already have on the table."

A changing mood: Despite their criticism, both executives said they see the current Commission becoming more receptive to their concerns. The priority now, they argued, is helping manufacturers that started the transition later rather than slowing down those already committed to electrification. As Gamboni put it: "Electrification is the right path and it must be irreversible."

The backdrop: Their comments accompany a new report by E-Mobility Europe and Ember arguing that meeting the EU's original 2030 electrification targets for cars, vans and trucks would save around 190 million barrels of oil a year, worth roughly €12 billion, while strengthening Europe's energy security. Cars, vans and trucks currently account for around two-thirds of the bloc's oil demand.

ROADWORTHINESS TALKS UNDERWAY: The European Parliament, Council and Commission on Thursday held the first negotiations for the Roadworthiness Package , aimed at updating the EU's rules for vehicle inspections and road safety.

The players: TRAN Committee Chair Eliza Vozemberg chaired the opening negotiations, alongside rapporteurs Jens Gieseke and Johan Danielsson. In a statement afterward, she said she looked forward to working with the Irish presidency to make "substantial progress" on the package in the coming months.

CLEPA: EU EVS AND HYBRIDS ALREADY MEET 'MADE IN EUROPE' TARGETS: Electric and hybrid vehicles manufactured in Europe already comfortably exceed the Commission's proposed 70 percent "Made in Europe" threshold under the Industrial Accelerator Act, according to a new Roland Berger analysis commissioned by the European Association of Automotive Suppliers.

The lobby highlighted that European-made components account for 89 percent of the value of plug-in hybrid electric vehicles and 83 percent of battery electric vehicles, "demonstrating that ambitious European content criteria are realistic and aligned with today's automotive supply chain," CLEPA said .

Lower targets, fewer jobs: That is why the lobby opposes watering down the Commission's proposed requirements, arguing that "every percentage point the EU weakens the Commission's 'Made in Europe' targets will result in direct job losses across the continent."

Contrasting views: Earlier this week, carmakers' lobby ACEA outlined its priorities for the proposal, including changing the methodology for calculating European content by subtracting the value of imported components from the vehicle's total value. It warned that the requirement to localize vehicle assembly and component production in the EU "will raise vehicle manufacturing costs."

MARITIME

CRUISE TAX BREAK UNDER FIRE: Cruise passengers pay significantly less tax than hotel guests despite the sector's environmental footprint, according to a new study by NGO Transport & Environment. It argues governments should close what it describes as a long-standing tax loophole.

The findings: Comparing €100-a-night holidays in France, Italy and Spain, the report found hotel guests pay an average tax rate of 23 percent, while cruise passengers pay 12 percent. T&E argues this stems from cruise ships being treated as maritime transport for tax purposes, allowing them to benefit from exemptions from VAT, fuel taxes and other levies.

The pushback: The report lands as European governments increasingly look at taxing cruise tourism. Barcelona last week backed plans to nearly triple its tourist tax on day-cruise passengers to €30. The

World Travel & Tourism Council warned that sharp tax increases could make destinations such as Barcelona less competitive than rival Mediterranean ports, reduce visitor spending and ultimately hurt local jobs and businesses. It instead called for closer cooperation between governments and the tourism industry to manage overtourism while maintaining the sector's economic contribution.

Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

EU shipyard races to service Putin's LNG fleet before sanctions bite
If the ships are serviced now, they'll be able to continue working despite looming EU sanctions.
By Martina Sapio · Jul 02, 2026, 06:00 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Weekly Calendar

Here's a selection of upcoming key events, find the complete Week Ahead online.

Pro Briefing – Uneasy alliance: What to expect at this week's NATO summit
Jul 6, 2026, 4:00 PM - 4:45 pm

Council Working Party on Land Transport
Jul 7, 2026 · Brussels, BE

EASA, Eurocontrol 'Satellite Navigation Under Threat: From Safety Risk to Coordinated Responses' workshop
Jul 7, 2026, 7:30 AM - Jul 8, 2026, 7:30 AM · Brussels, BE

London Playbook Live 2026
Jul 7, 2026, 5:00 PM - 7:00 pm

POLITICO Summer Party 2026
Jul 7, 2026, 6:30 PM - 10:00 pm

Coreper I
Jul 8, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Coreper II
Jul 8, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Pro Roundtable – Tech UK
Jul 9, 2026, 9:00 AM - 11:00 am

Pro Intelligence Connections
2021/0211(COD) Revision of the EU Emissions Tradin…
Discussions within the Council or its preparatory…
2021/0205(COD) Sustainable aviation fuels (ReFuelE…
Discussions within the Council or its preparatory…
Updated rules for safer roads, less air pollution…
Apr 24, 2025 • European Commission - Press release